

MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

FROM RELIGIOUS DIVISION TO THE ARMADA: HOW DID ELIZABETH SECURE HER THRONE?

*Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88 – Key
Topic 2: Challenges to Elizabeth at home and
abroad, 1569-88*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade		9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title		Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home				
L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain				
L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for, and the significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569–70).
- ☐ Analyse the key features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- ☐ Evaluate the methods used by Sir Francis Walsingham and his use of spies to uncover treason.
- ☐ Explain the reasons for, and the immense geopolitical significance of, Mary, Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

What was Elizabeth's immediate reaction to Mary's arrival?

Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a massive threat to Elizabeth?

What was the Casket Letters affair?

What was the Papal Bull of 1570?

What was the 'Crucifix Controversy'?

What were the Royal Injunctions?

How much debt did Elizabeth inherit?

What was the 'Auld Alliance'?

What did William Harvey discover?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least TWO of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Treason | Excommunication

Q1. What were the main causes of the Revolt of the Northern Earls?

Q2. How did the 1570 Papal Bull change the nature of the Catholic threat?

Q3. Vocabulary in Context: What was the role of a 'Spymaster', and why was Walsingham successful?

Q4. Causal Linkage: How did the Babington Plot directly lead to Mary's execution?

Q5. Constrained Summary: Summarise the evolution of Catholic plots between 1569 and 1586 in one sentence.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Which plot posed the greatest danger to Elizabeth's life?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70.

Q8. Describe one feature of the Ridolfi plot.

Q9. Describe one feature of the Throckmorton plot.

Q10. Describe one feature of the Babington plot.

Q11. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's use of spies.

Q12. Explain why the Revolt of the Northern Earls took place in 1569. Stimulus: Loss of political power / Religion

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Q13. Explain why Mary, Queen of Scots, was executed in 1587. [Aligned to Spec Topic]
Stimulus: The Babington Plot / Sir Francis Walsingham

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Q14. 'The main reason for the failure of Catholic plots against Elizabeth was the work of Sir Francis Walsingham.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Spies / Lack of foreign support

Q15. 'The Revolt of the Northern Earls was the most significant challenge to Elizabeth's rule in the years 1569–86.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Earl of Northumberland / Babington's execution (1586)



Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

General Notes

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L2: KT2.2: Relations with Spain

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the complex roots of the Anglo-Spanish conflict, focusing on religious, political, and commercial rivalry.
- ☐ Explain the significance of English involvement in the Netherlands, specifically the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch.
- ☐ Analyse the causes and Philip II's strategic plan for the Spanish Armada.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the Armada's catastrophic failure, weighing English tactics against Spanish mistakes and the weather.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?

What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?

What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

Who was Francis Walsingham?

Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?

What was the Casket Letters affair?

Who was the Pope that excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570?

What was the Act of Uniformity?

Who published the Germ Theory?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Privateer | Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) | Galleon | Fireships

Your Sentence:

Q1. Identify the three main causes of rivalry between England and Spain.

Q2. Why was the Netherlands so crucial to both Philip II and Elizabeth?

Q3. The 'But/Because/So' Strategy: Philip II launched the Armada in 1588, BUT...

Q4. What was the significance of the 'Singeing of the King of Spain's beard' at Cadiz?

Q5. Causal Linkage: Why did the Armada's plan to meet the Duke of Parma fail?

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did relations with Spain deteriorate so badly by the 1580s?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of English privateering in the New World.

Q8. Describe one feature of the religious rivalry between England and Spain.

Q9. Describe one feature of Sir Francis Drake's activities in the Americas.

Q10. Explain why relations between England and Spain became worse in the years 1569–88. Stimulus: Catholic rebels in England / English trade in the Netherlands

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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Q11. 'Commercial rivalry was the main cause of the growing tension between England and Spain in the years 1570–88.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Privateering / Religious differences



Pupil Voice

Which part of today's lesson did you find the most difficult or confusing, and what did you do to overcome it?

General Notes

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L3: KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain, focusing on religious shifts, the Genoese Loan, the assassination of William of Orange, and the Treaty of Joinville.
- ☐ Analyse the significance of English direct involvement in the Netherlands through the 1585 Treaty of Nonsuch and the actions of Robert Dudley.
- ☐ Evaluate the strategic impact of Francis Drake's preemptive raid on Cadiz in 1587 ('Singeing the King of Spain's beard').

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did Philip II of Spain angry with Elizabeth?

What was a 'privateer'?

Which famous English privateer constantly raided Spanish treasure ships?

What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?

How much gold did Drake capture from the Spanish ship Cacafuego?

Who was Francis Walsingham?

What was the Babington Plot (1586)?

What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?

Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a threat?

What was the 'Vestment Controversy'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Privateer**

Q1. How did the 'Genoese Loan' incident escalate tensions in 1568?

Q2. Why did the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585) act as the 'point of no return'?

Q3. Why was Robert Dudley's expedition to the Netherlands a failure?

Q4. Evaluate: Was the Spanish Armada mostly defeated by English skill or by Spanish mistakes?

Q5. Constrained Summary: Summarise the path to war between 1585 and 1588 in three steps.

Pair & Share Activity

Q6. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was the outbreak of war with Spain in 1585 inevitable?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q7. Describe one feature of English involvement in the Netherlands, 1585–88.

Q8. Describe one feature of Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Q9. Describe one feature of Robert Dudley's actions in the Netherlands.

Q10. Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch in 1585. Stimulus: The Netherlands / Dutch Protestant rebels

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]

[illegible]

Q11. 'Drake's raid on Cadiz was the most important reason for the delay of the Spanish Armada.' How far do you agree? Stimulus: Wooden barrel staves / Financial impact on Spain



Pupil Voice

If you were teaching this lesson to Year 6, what is the ONE most important thing you would make sure they remembered?

General Notes

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England (1558–88)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)